

Find out who actually understood the lesson — in two minutes, with no marking.

Get It? is a free tool for teachers while it's in beta. You type the topic. It writes the questions. Pupils answer on their phones with one code — no logins, no apps — and you get one screen back:

● got it ● shaky ● faking

THIS RESOURCE: THE SIX TELLS — AND THREE QUESTIONS THAT FLUSH THEM OUT

Every class has them. The pupil who nods in the right places, copies the board neatly, and agrees with whoever spoke last. They are not lazy, and they are not disengaged — they are embarrassed. Being lost in front of twenty-nine people is a social risk, and they have decided it is not worth taking. So they have learned a set of moves that make them invisible. Here is what to look for.

1 The echo

You ask a question and they answer using your own words back at you — "*so it's the mitochondria*". If the only phrasing they can produce is the one they just heard, they have memorised a sound, not built an idea. The tell: they can't say it a second, different way, and they can't answer "why?"

2 The confident wrong answer

Speed is often a substitute for certainty. The pupil who fires an answer out fast and loud is sometimes the one who most needs the question to be over before anyone looks too closely. Confidence is worth watching as a signal — it correlates with knowing, but not as strongly as we assume.

3 They agree with whoever spoke last

Ask the same question twice in a different order and watch the answer move. If it flips to match the pupil who answered before them, they are reading the room, not the question. This is why "*who agrees with that?*" is one of the worst questions in teaching — it rewards exactly the behaviour you are trying to catch.

4 Perfect notes, blank page

The book is beautiful — every heading underlined, every diagram copied. Then you ask them to start the exercise and nothing happens. Copying is a low-risk way to look busy, and it produces a page that looks like evidence of learning without being any.

5 The shrug with a smile

"*I don't get it*" delivered as a joke, with a laugh, so that it doesn't count as asking. It's a real request for help wearing a disguise. Take it seriously and drop the joke — that pupil just took the biggest risk they were willing to take today.

6 The one who helps everyone else

Being the explainer is a great way to never be tested. Some pupils take the helper role precisely because it keeps the focus off their own understanding. Ask them to *do* it rather than explain it. The two are not the same.

WHY YOU CAN'T CATCH THIS BY EYE

You have thirty of them and one of you. The pupils who are best at hiding it are the ones you notice least — because by design they never give you a reason to look.

And there's a second problem: the moment you ask a question out loud, you've made it public. The pupil who most needs to answer honestly is the one with the most to lose by doing so.

THREE QUESTIONS THAT FLUSH IT OUT

You don't need to catch them in the act. You need a question they can't fake.

"Which of these two is wrong, and why?"

Give two plausible answers. This cannot be done by recall, and the wrong one catches the specific misconception. Someone bluffing has to actually think — and thinking out loud is where it shows.

"Explain it as if I've never seen it before."

Forces their own words. If they can only give you yours, you've found the echo.

"What would happen if...?"

Change one thing and ask. Recall doesn't transfer. Understanding does.

And ask the quiet ones first — before the confident ones have set the answer for the room.

WHAT TO DO WHEN YOU FIND ONE

Don't make it public. The whole reason they are hiding is that being seen not to know feels worse than not knowing. This is the argument for private, per-pupil answers rather than hands up — when every pupil answers on their own screen and only you can see the result, the pupil who is lost can say so at no social cost. You find out in two minutes what a whole lesson of questioning was hiding.

Try it on one class

One lesson. One question. Two minutes. If it doesn't tell you something you didn't already know, walk away.

app.dotheygetit.app

Free for teachers while in beta — no card, no install. Students never need an account.